



MONTHLY UPDATE

Burkina Faso: monthly update, July – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-27 · 53 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · GEOPOLITICS

Summary of the month

The legislature [voted a data-protection law and an organic law merging the broadcasting regulator with the data-protection commission on 3 August 2026](#); neither is promulgated. Two days earlier, automated traffic enforcement went live and [detected 1,099 offences in its first twelve hours](#). The Council of Ministers adopted three decrees on 30 July — mass biometric enrolment, critical-infrastructure classification and security-audit accreditation — and the digital ministry [put 120 externally hosted public platforms on the record for the first time](#).

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

Policy work this month was procedural rather than substantive. The digital transition ministry [held a CASEM session on what it contributes to the RELANCE 2026-2030 national plan](#). The plan text, the digital component, any budget line and any target are all unpublished, so what the record holds is that the process is running and not what it is expected to produce.

Legislation and regulation

The Council of Ministers of 23 July restricted recourse to the fast-track procurement route to sovereignty, strategic character, threats to public order or service continuity, and humanitarian consequences of insecurity — at the same sitting that used the route for a schools package of about FCFA 38bn.

On the statute book already in force, a press-freedom organisation [presented a report on 14 August arguing that cybercrime laws in Burkina Faso, Mali, Niger and Guinea are being used against journalists](#), and urged repeal of the vague public-order and human-dignity provisions it says carry the prosecutions. The report is an advocacy account; the base holds no case record for it.

Data protection

On 3 August the legislature [voted the personal-data protection bill and the organic law creating a merged communications and data-protection authority](#). The new law prohibits and sanctions processing without consent, indexes administrative fines to turnover excluding tax and scales them by gravity, and prohibits transferring sensitive data abroad. The merged authority takes the data-protection commission's mandate and is given its own rule-making power with artificial intelligence named specifically. Neither text is held, neither is promulgated, and no commencement, seat or leadership is stated.

The same 23 July sitting replaced the 2017 decree governing the non-profit register, fixing for the first time a retention period for that data after dissolution.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

The same organic law creating the merged communications and data-protection authority folds the broadcasting regulator into it, transferring its mandate subject to promulgation; neither text is held and no commencement, seat or leadership is stated.

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

The Council of Ministers of 23 July [approved a revised finance law raising both receipts and spending while leaving the deficit unchanged, and recorded 47.30% budget execution at 30 June](#).

New investments

A digital acceleration project stated on 13 July that it will support connectivity to [1,000 localities in 2026](#) against nearly 2,000 still without mobile or internet service, expected to benefit one and a half to two million people, most of them rural. No regulator or ministry primary states whether that count is of telecom sites or of localities served.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

At the Prime Minister's mid-year review of 25 July the digital ministry reported 46.7% physical execution of its 2026 objectives contract, the replacement public-administration network's architecture finalised with suppliers' bids under evaluation, and [satellite-operator admission negotiations advancing](#); that operator remains unlicensed.

The regulator ran a four-day workshop with territorial authorities from 29 June to 2 July, naming local opposition and misinformation as continuing brakes on tower rollout. At an address-protocol forum on 3 July the regulator and operators again called for a migration plan with a firm calendar; none is adopted.

The month's one new external route is a proposal rather than a link. Burkina Faso and Nigerian digital ministries [met in Ouagadougou on 12 August to explore connecting Nigeria's planned 90,000km open-access fibre backbone into Burkina Faso](#), alongside cooperation on artificial intelligence in local languages, digital public infrastructure, cybersecurity and skills, and [a stated aim of halving internet costs through that backbone](#). No instrument was signed and the Nigerian backbone is itself unbuilt.

Data Storage

A wholly domestic commercial hosting provider [launched on 31 July](#) with more than 600 domain names, more than 196 web hostings and 98% availability at launch — the vendor's own figures, with capacity, tier and certification unstated.

Cybersecurity

The Council of Ministers of 30 July [adopted two decrees applying the 2024 information-systems security law](#): one identifying, classifying and setting obligations for critical-infrastructure bodies, expressly spanning energy, water, health, telecommunications and finance, and one fixing periodic security audits and vesting auditor accreditation in the national cyberspace control body. The law had asserted both duties since July 2024 with no machinery attached.

The building meant to carry the supervision got its first progress statement in seven months. The digital transition minister [inspected the site on 5 August](#), where the technical managers put physical execution across that worksite and the first citizen service centre together at about 20%; the account names the build the Centre d'opération du Réseau Backbone national and gives it the same supervisory function the January account gave the supervision centre. The stated delivery month is October 2026.

DPI

Digital Identity and CRVS

The Council of Ministers of 30 July also [adopted the decree organising mass registration for the unique electronic identifier](#), through committees run entirely by public structures so that fingerprint and iris data stay in-country, with mass enrolment targeted before end-2026. Enrolment had not begun as at 5 August, and the decree states no target, budget or supervisory authority. A Nigerien technical mission was received on 30 July.

Digital Payments and Fintech

The regional instant-payment rail moved its deadlines rather than its coverage: the central bank [extended connection to 30 September 2026 for banks and payment institutions and 30 June 2027 for microfinance](#), with 80 institutions connected union-wide at 24 June and 74 more in test.

Registries

An estate-agency register launched on 21 July with a compulsory card applied for and tracked wholly online and commissions capped.

Sectoral management information systems

A [pension acts platform was announced as the completion of the pension programme, joining the pension fund, the civil-service directorate and the budget directorate on a single pension file](#). No date, budget, vendor or scope is stated.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Automated traffic enforcement entered operation at midnight on 1 August after an April pilot, reading plates against the vehicle database, serving fines by message with a link to the national payments rail, and immobilising vehicles for non-payment within a month. It [logged 1,099 offences between midnight and noon that day](#) and five payments. Neither held account reports a legal basis, retention rule or data-protection authorisation; [the justification given is 15,614 road accidents in 2025](#). A pension formalities portal also launched on 21 July, presented as improving data exchange between three administrations rather than as a web front end. The Council of Ministers of 23 July separately converted the trade single window's operator into a state company.

The health ministry's accreditation portal, launched on 7 August, arrived with the one thing most of these launches lack — a use figure. It had taken [more than 247 applications since a soft launch in April 2026, of which 39 were validated](#) by the day of the official launch. The counts are the ministry's own, and the record does not explain the gap between the two.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

Citizen service centres stand at [two pilot sites under construction, with architectural studies under way for a further city, eight regional capitals and fifty rural communes](#), against a state and postal-service contract for twenty spaces over five years. No unit cost and no beneficiary count is published. The first of the pilots [now has a name, Zama Tchey, and was inspected on 5 August](#); it is to bring postal, financial and digital services closer to the population. A second inspection two days later [put the first Maison du citoyen at 20% complete](#), one of twelve structuring digitalisation projects the ministry names, and took in the national fibre backbone's network operations centre on the same visit.

Technology

AI

At a regional digital salon on 14 to 16 July, the monetary union's commission announced it would prepare a community artificial-intelligence strategy, counting this country among four member states already holding a national one — a count another source published five days earlier contradicts. An operator pitched credit scoring built on mobile-money patterns at the same event; no model-disclosure duty or contestation route for an automated refusal is on file. Six francophone West African states adopted common governance guidelines announced on 6 July, non-binding and complementary to national strategies.

Asked in plenary where AI sat in the new data-protection law, the justice minister said it was already integrated via the ban on transferring sensitive data abroad, with the national roadmap to become dedicated regulation later.

Innovation ecosystem

The first Sahel Tech Innovation Challenge closed in Ouagadougou, taking 600 submitted projects from 23 African countries down to 100, then 60, then 10 finalists. First prize went to a [Burkinabe agricultural artificial-intelligence tool built to work in national languages](#). No prize value, follow-on funding or second edition is announced.

Capacity

Literacy

That agency and a payments operator opened a 72-hour financial-education campaign on 28 July, extending a partnership running since 2025 to four cities.

Training and skills

The Prime Minister's office ran a two-day session for its senior managers on 13 and 14 July on management tools for ethical and responsible artificial intelligence, a second round after a first for all staff. A parliamentary technology body [trained about thirty lawmakers on 16 July](#) to prepare their review of future legislation.

An operator digital centre marked five years of operation at a ministerial visit on 4 July. The Council of Ministers of 23 July approved the statutes of a technology academy, with no intake, curriculum or budget on record.

Inclusion

Access to services

A financial inclusion agency delivered training and consumer protection this month, not its regulator.

Geopolitics

China activities

The month's only Chinese item is an approach rather than an agreement: the communications minister and a Burkinabe delegation were [received at a Chinese broadcaster's Beijing headquarters on 22 August 2026 to examine partnership in audiovisual and digital broadcasting, the exchanges going to the terms of collaboration with the national broadcaster and the national transmission company](#). No memorandum, commitment, value or timetable is stated.

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